

Kindergarten Ontario Curriculum Mathematical Learning

Shape Safari

Unit Overview: Shape Safari

Grade: Kindergarten | **Strand:** Mathematical Learning

Target Expectations: A9.1, A9.2, A9.3, A9.4, A9.5, A9.6, A9.7

Learning Goal: Children will identify, describe, and compose 2D and 3D shapes; use positional language; and apply shapes in art.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	2D Shape Hunt	I can identify and describe 2D shapes.
Day 2	3D Shape Hunt	I can identify and describe 3D shapes.
Day 3	Where Is It?	I can describe location with positional words.
Day 4	Build and Break	I can compose and decompose shapes.
Day 5	Shape Safari Art Capstone	I can use shapes to make a safari picture and describe it.

Lesson 1: 2D Shape Hunt

Goal: 2D shapes are FLAT. Circle, triangle, square, rectangle, hexagon. Each has a name and properties.

Expectation: A9.1

Learning Goal: "I can identify and describe 2D shapes."

Materials: M1_2d_shape_set, M7_shape_chart, M10_safari_poster

1. Minds On (7 mins): Sammy's 2D Hunt

Sammy spots a CIRCLE in the safari! What other 2D shapes can we find?

Bring children to the carpet. Sammy puppet. 'Friends — I'm Sammy the Safari Sloth. Today we hunt 2D shapes.'

2. Action (20 mins): Shape Hunt Stations

- Whole group: identify 5 shapes by properties.
- Three stations.
- Stretch challenge at Station C: name a shape and find 3 examples.
- Discuss properties.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the shape tracker.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sammy's Shape Brag

Discuss:

- What does 2D mean?
- How do you tell a circle from a square?
- Where did you find shapes?
- What's a hexagon?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 2: 3D Shape Hunt

Goal: 3D shapes are SOLID. Sphere, cube, cylinder, cone, pyramid. They have faces, edges, vertices.

Expectation: A9.2

Learning Goal: "I can identify and describe 3D shapes."

Materials: M2_3d_shape_set, M7_shape_chart, M10_safari_poster

1. Minds On (7 mins): Sammy and Mira's 3D Tour

Sammy holds a SPHERE — like a real ball. What other 3D shapes can we find?

Bring children to the carpet. Sammy + Mira puppets. 'Yesterday we hunted FLAT 2D shapes. Today we hunt SOLID 3D shapes.'

2. Action (20 mins): 3D Shape Stations

- Whole group: identify 5 3D shapes by handling.
- Three stations.
- Stretch challenge at Station C: count faces of each 3D shape.
- Discuss faces, edges, vertices.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the 3D tracker.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sammy's 3D Brag

Discuss:

- What does 3D mean?
- What's a sphere?
- How is a cube different from a square?
- What 3D shapes did you find in the classroom?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 3: Where Is It?

Goal: Positional words describe LOCATION. Above, below, beside, inside, outside, between.

Expectation: A9.3, A9.6

Learning Goal: "I can describe location with positional words."

Materials: M3_safari_map, M4_position_cards, M8_position_chart, M9_animal_set

1. Minds On (7 mins): Mira's Treasure Map

Mira made a map. The lion is ABOVE the river. The zebra is BELOW the tree. Where is the elephant?

Bring children to the carpet. Sammy + Mira puppets. 'Yesterday we named shapes. Today Mira helps us describe LOCATION using POSITION words.'

2. Action (20 mins): Position Stations

- Whole group: practice 6 position words with classroom objects.
- Three stations.
- Stretch challenge at Station C: use 2 position words ('above and beside').
- Discuss meaning.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the positional tracker.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Mira's Position Brag

Discuss:

- What does ABOVE mean?
- What's the difference between INSIDE and OUTSIDE?
- When do we use BETWEEN?
- Where is your bag right now?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 4: Build and Break

Goal: Bigger shapes are made of smaller shapes. 2 triangles can build a square. We compose and decompose.

Expectation: A9.4, A9.5

Learning Goal: "I can compose and decompose shapes."

Materials: M1_2d_shape_set, M2_3d_shape_set, M5_pattern_blocks, M7_shape_chart

1. Minds On (7 mins): Sammy Builds a Hexagon

Sammy: I have 6 triangles. Can I make a hexagon? Watch — yes!

Bring children to the carpet. Sammy + Mira puppets. 'Friends — yesterday we used position words. Today Sammy shows us COMPOSE and DECOMPOSE.'

2. Action (20 mins): Build and Break Stations

- Whole group: compose 4 shapes from pattern blocks.
- Three stations.
- Stretch challenge at Station C: build a structure using all 5 different 3D shapes.
- Discuss the big idea.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the compose/decompose tracker.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sammy's Build Brag

Discuss:

- What does COMPOSE mean?
- What does DECOMPOSE mean?
- What 2 shapes compose a square?
- What 3D structure did you build?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 5: Shape Safari Art Capstone

Goal: Shapes are everywhere — in art, animals, buildings. We use shapes to make pictures.

Expectation: A9.1, A9.2, A9.3, A9.4, A9.5, A9.7

Learning Goal: "I can use shapes to make a safari picture and describe it."

Materials: M1_2d_shape_set, M2_3d_shape_set, M3_safari_map, M5_pattern_blocks

1. Minds On (7 mins): Mira's Safari Picture

Mira: Look at this safari! A circle sun ABOVE the trees. A square hut BELOW the hill. Triangles for the giraffe!

Bring children to the carpet. Sammy + Mira puppets. 'Friends — today is our CAPSTONE. We use everything: 2D shapes, 3D shapes, position words, compose and decompose. We make a SAFARI PICTURE.'

2. Action (20 mins): Build Your Safari Picture

- Hand out capstone templates and pattern blocks.
- Children glue or trace pattern blocks onto the template.
- Stretch challenge: include a 3D model in the foreground (sphere as a planet, cube as a hut).
- Pair-share: each child describes their picture to a partner using shape names AND position words.
- Circulate to record summative evidence on the capstone rubric.

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Safari Gallery Walk

Discuss:

- Show ONE shape in your picture.
- Did you compose a bigger shape?
- Where is the sun in your picture?
- Where is the animal you drew?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Sammy's Shape Hunt

Learning Goal: I can identify and describe 2D shapes.

Mission

1. Draw a line from each shape to its name.
2. Look at each shape.
3. Look around your classroom.

Part 3: Find shapes in your classroom!

Look around your classroom. Find 3 things that have a 2D shape. Draw each one. Write the shape name beside your

Name: _____

Date: _____

Mira's 3D Hunt

Learning Goal: I can identify and describe 3D shapes.

Mission

1. Draw a line from each 3D shape to its name.
2. Look at each shape.
3. Look around your classroom.

Part 3: Find 3D shapes in your classroom!

Look around your classroom. Find 3 things that are 3D. Draw each one. Write the 3D shape name beside your drawing.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Mira's Position Map

Learning Goal: I can describe location with positional words.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each picture.
2. Read each clue.
3. Look around your classroom.

Part 3: Where is it?

Look around your classroom. Pick 3 things. Write where each one is using a position word.

[illegible]

Name: _____

Date: _____

Sammy's Build and Break

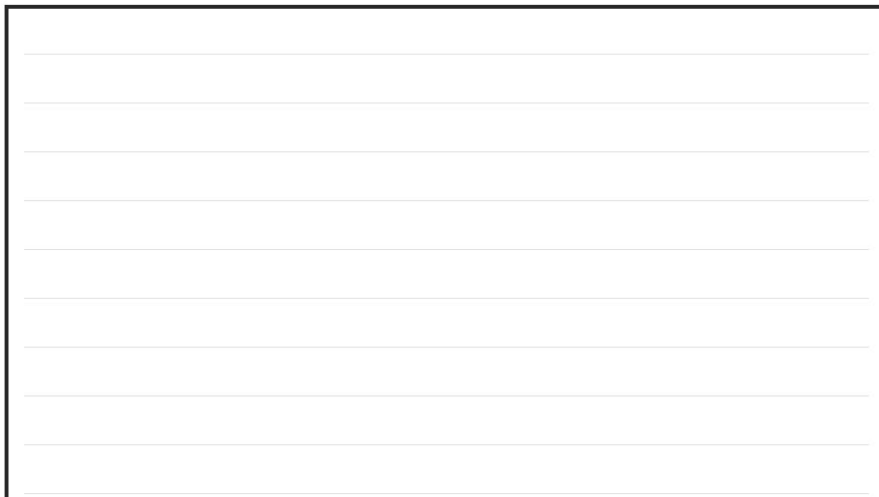
Learning Goal: I can compose and decompose shapes.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each target shape.
2. Look at each big shape.
3. Draw a 3D structure you built with blocks.

Part 3: Draw your 3D structure!

Draw a 3D structure you built with blocks. Label the 3D shapes you used.

A large rectangular box with a black border, containing ten horizontal lines for drawing a 3D structure.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Sammy's Safari Capstone

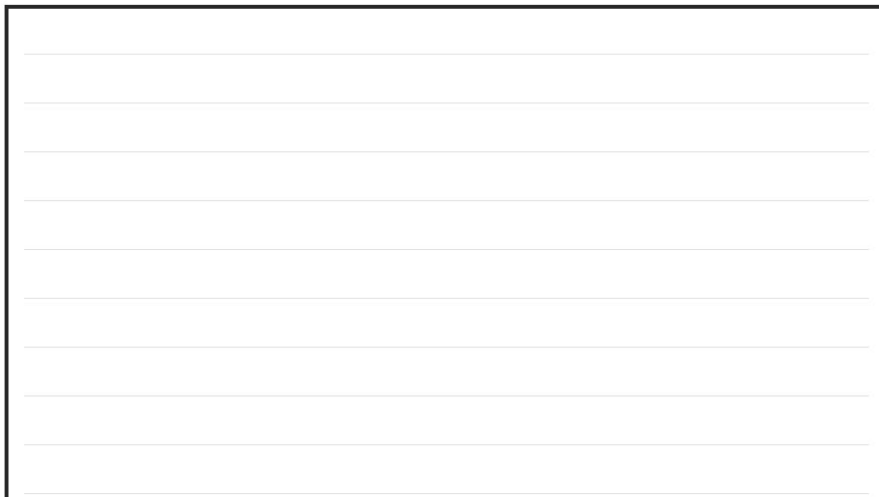
Learning Goal: I can use shapes to make a safari picture and describe it.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Pick 5 shapes you will use in your safari picture.
2. Use your plan to draw a safari picture.
3. Write 3 sentences about your picture using position words.

Part 2: Build your safari picture!

Use your plan to draw a safari picture. Compose at least 1 bigger shape from smaller shapes.

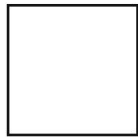
A large rectangular box with a black border, containing ten horizontal lines for drawing a safari picture.

2D Shape Cards

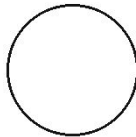
(M1_2d_shape_set)

A set of 30 paper shape tokens used by pairs to identify, sort, compose, and place 2D shapes throughout the unit.

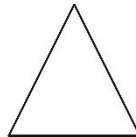
2D Shapes



square



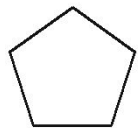
circle



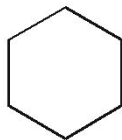
triangle



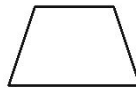
rectangle



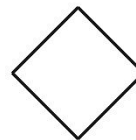
pentagon



hexagon



trapezoid



rhombus

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 1, 4, 5

Prep: ~25 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets total (1 set per pair for a class of 20).

2. Laminate before cutting for durability across multiple lessons.

3. Cut along the thin solid lines into 30 individual shape tokens per set.

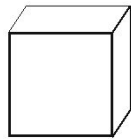
4. Store each set in a labelled zip-top bag ('2D Shape Set — Pair 1', etc.).

3D Shape Models

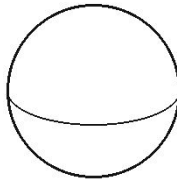
(M2_3d_shape_set)

A set of 5 paper-fold 3D shapes (sphere/round-disc, cube, cylinder, cone, pyramid) for hands-on 3D shape exploration.

3D Solids



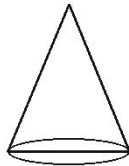
cube



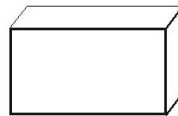
sphere



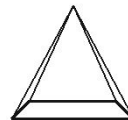
cylinder



cone



rect prism



pyramid

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 3

Laminate: no

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 2, 4, 5

Prep: ~45 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 6 sets (1 per pair plus 2 extras).

2. Cut along solid lines and fold along dashed lines for each net.

3. Tape or glue tabs to assemble cube, cone, cylinder, pyramid (~5 min per set).

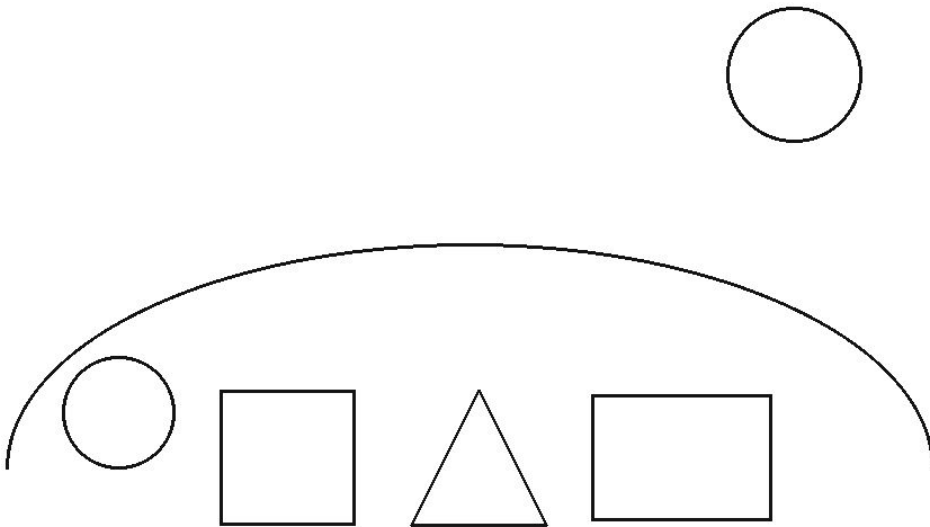
4. Store assembled shapes in a labelled box per pair.

Safari Map Mat

(M3_safari_map)

A letter-size safari scene with positional pockets used for placing safari animals according to position-word clues.

Shape Safari



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10-12 mats

Lessons: 3, 5

Prep: ~15 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 12 mats (1 per pair plus 2 extras).

2. Laminate every mat for repeated dry-erase use across lessons 3 and 5.

3. Distribute one mat per pair; keep extras at the teacher table.

Position Word Cards

(M4_position_cards)

Set of 12 cards with position words (above, below, beside, inside, outside, between) and matching arrow/diagram icons.

Position Words

LEFT	RIGHT	UP	DOWN
ABOVE	BELOW	INSIDE	OUTSIDE

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 3

Prep: ~20 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets (1 per pair).

2. Laminate before cutting for durability.

3. Cut along the grid lines into 12 individual cards per set.

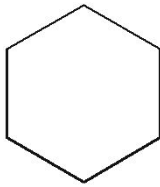
4. Store each set in a labelled zip-top bag.

Paper Pattern Blocks

(M5_pattern_blocks)

A set of 60 paper pattern blocks (triangles, squares, hexagons, trapezoids, rhombi) used by pairs to compose and decompose shapes.

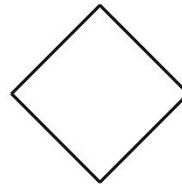
Pattern Blocks



hexagon



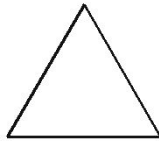
trapezoid



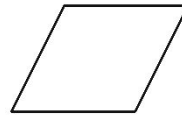
rhombus



square



triangle



parallel

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 4, 5

Prep: ~35 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets (1 per pair).

2. Laminate before cutting for repeated use.

3. Cut apart along the thin solid lines into 60 individual blocks per set.

4. Store each set in a labelled zip-top bag with a small label of the contents.

Safari Art Capstone Template

(M6_capstone_template)

A letter-size template for the Lesson 5 safari shape-art capstone.

Safari Art Capstone Template	
1	Capstone _____
2	Frame _____
3	Shapes _____
4	Safari Art Capstone Template _____

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 25 templates

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~5 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 25 templates (1 per child plus 5 extras for revisions).

2. Stack near the teacher table for distribution at the start of Lesson 5 Action.

3. No lamination needed — these are single-use summative artifacts.

Shape Anchor Chart

(M7_shape_chart)

A teacher-display anchor chart showing 2D and 3D shape names with visual examples and properties.

Shape Attributes

- Sides — straight or curved?
- Corners — how many?
- Equal sides?
- Right angles?
- Symmetry — does it match?

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape
Colour: bw
Pages per set: 1
Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart for the classroom
Lessons: 1, 2, 4
Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy on standard letter paper (or scale to 11x17 if available).
2. Laminate for repeated reference across the unit.
3. Tape to the front classroom wall before Lesson 1.

Positional Language Chart

(M8_position_chart)

A teacher-display anchor chart of position words with picture examples.

Position Words

LEFT	RIGHT	UP	DOWN
ABOVE	BELOW	INSIDE	OUTSIDE

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 chart for the classroom

Lessons: 3, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

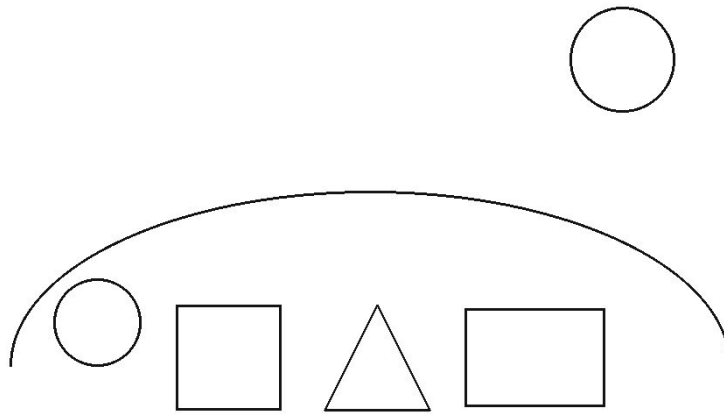
1. Print 1 copy on standard letter paper.
2. Laminate for repeated use across Lessons 3 and 5.
3. Tape next to the Shape Anchor Chart on the front classroom wall.

Safari Animal Tokens

(M9_animal_set)

A set of 12 small paper safari animal tokens (lion, elephant, giraffe, zebra, monkey, snake) used to place on the Safari Map Mat for position-word activities.

Shape Safari



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 10 sets

Lessons: 3, 5

Prep: ~20 min

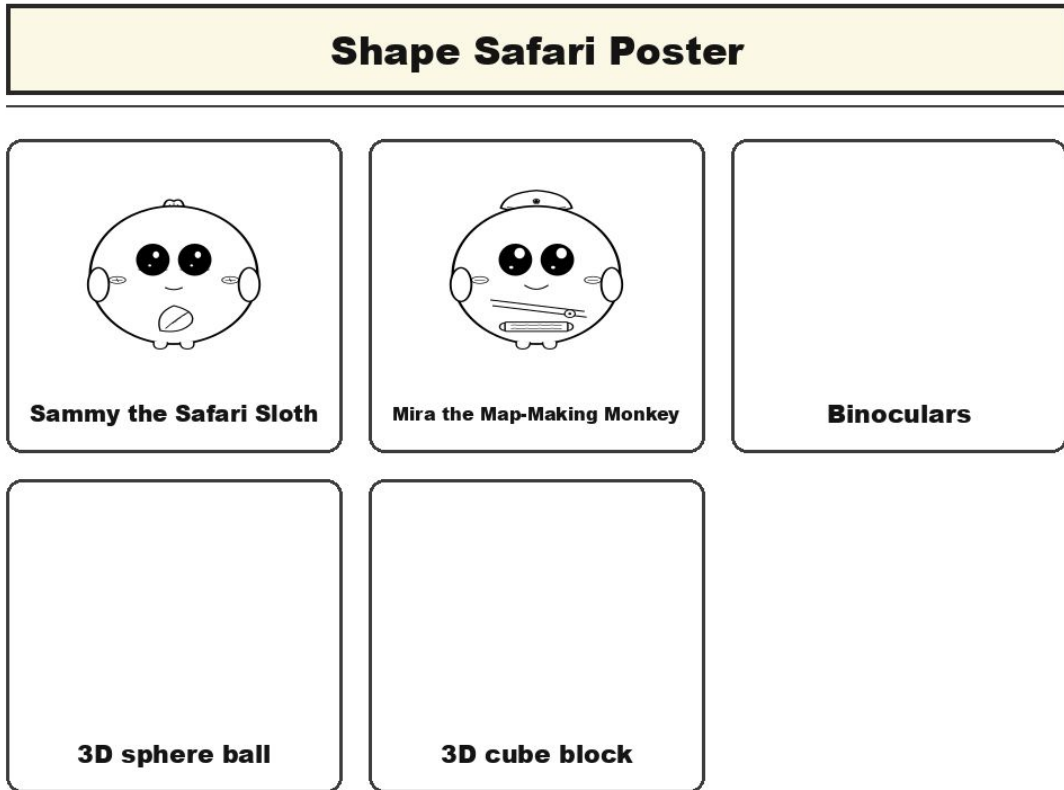
TEACHER PREP

1. Print 10 sets (1 per pair).
2. Laminate before cutting for durability across lessons 3 and 5.
3. Cut apart into 12 individual tokens per set.
4. Store each set in a labelled zip-top bag together with the Safari Map Mat.

Shape Safari Poster

(M10_safari_poster)

A unit anchor poster featuring Sammy and Mira surrounded by safari shapes.



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 poster for the classroom

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy on standard letter paper (or scale to 11x17 if available).

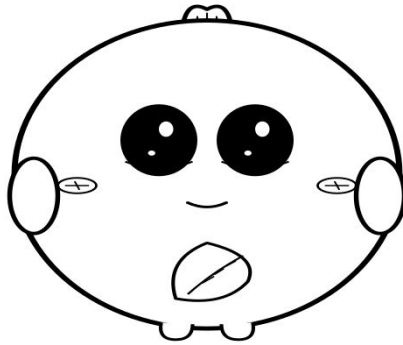
2. Laminate the poster for the full unit duration.

3. Tape to the front classroom wall on Day 1 before Lesson 1 begins.

Sammy Puppet

(char_sammy_puppet)

A paper puppet of Sammy the Safari Sloth used by the teacher in the Minds-On phase of every lesson to introduce concepts in child voice.



Sammy the Safari Sloth

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for teacher use

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy of Sammy on cardstock if possible.

2. Cut around the outside of Sammy's silhouette including the bottom tab.

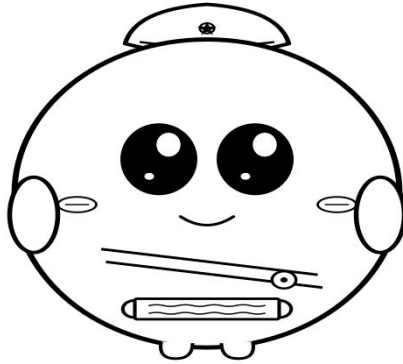
3. Laminate before assembly for durability.

4. Add a stick handle.

Mira Puppet

(char_mira_puppet)

A paper puppet of Mira the Map-Making Monkey used by the teacher in Lessons 3, 4, and 5 to introduce position words and capstone instructions.



Mira the Map Monkey

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for teacher use

Lessons: 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~12 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 copy of Mira on cardstock if possible.

2. Cut around the outside of Mira's silhouette including the bottom tab.

3. Laminate before assembly for durability.

4. Add a stick handle.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
A9.1 identify, describe, and compare 2D shapes	With significant adult prompting, names 1-2 2D shapes only some of the time. Does not yet describe properties.	Names 3-4 2D shapes most of the time with prompts. Describes basic properties (round vs straight) when asked.	Independently names 5 2D shapes (circle, triangle, square, rectangle, hexagon) and describes properties using shape vocabulary.	Names additional 2D shapes (oval, pentagon, semicircle) beyond the core 5 and spontaneously identifies 2D shapes in the
A9.2 identify, describe, and compare 3D shapes	Cannot consistently distinguish 2D from 3D. May call all shapes 'shapes' without flat/solid distinction.	Names 1-2 3D shapes (typically cube and sphere). Recognizes 3D as 'solid' when prompted.	Independently names 5 3D shapes (sphere, cube, cylinder, cone, pyramid) and clearly distinguishes 2D from 3D using flat/solid	Articulates faces, edges, and vertices for 3D shapes and recognizes that 3D shapes have 2D faces (e.g., 'a cube's face is a
A9.3 use positional language (above, below, beside, inside, outside)	Uses 1-2 position words (typically 'in' and 'on') for everything. Does not yet differentiate above/below or inside/outside	Uses 3-4 position words with prompts. May still confuse above with below or inside with between.	Independently uses 5+ position words (above, below, beside, inside, outside) accurately to describe object placement.	Combines two position words ('above and beside') and applies position vocabulary spontaneously across the day.
A9.4 compose and decompose 2D shapes	Stacks pattern blocks randomly without a target. Cannot identify when a bigger shape can be made from smaller ones.	Composes a square from 2 triangles or a hexagon from 6 triangles with adult prompts. Decomposing remains difficult.	Independently composes target shapes (square, hexagon, rectangle, house) from pattern blocks AND decomposes a bigger shape into	Composes the same target shape two different ways (e.g., hexagon = 6 triangles OR 2 trapezoids) and explains why both work.
A9.5 build with 3D shapes	Stacks 3D shapes randomly without a target. Cannot name the shapes used in a structure.	Builds a simple structure (tower from cubes) and names 1-2 of the 3D shapes used.	Independently builds a multi-shape 3D structure (bridge, house, tower) AND names which 3D shapes were used.	Builds a structure using all 5 different 3D shapes AND describes the structure using position words ('the cone is above the
A9.6 describe location with positional language	Describes location only with pointing or 'here'/'there'. Cannot articulate position relationships in words.	Describes object location with 1-2 position words when prompted. Often confuses similar pairs (above/below).	Independently describes object location using full 'The ____ is ____ the ____' sentence frame with correct position words.	Produces multi-clause descriptions ('the lion is above the rocks AND beside the tree') and uses position words across the school
A9.7 use shapes in art and patterns	Free-draws without using identifiable shapes. Cannot name shapes in their own	Includes 2-3 shapes in their artwork with prompts. Can name some of the shapes	Independently uses 5+ different shapes in a safari picture, composes at least one	Mixes 2D and 3D representations in artwork, includes a composed shape with

Junior Shape Explorer Certificate

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day Shape Safari unit and demonstrating the skills of a Shape Explorer. A safari shape certificate. Sammy the Safari Sloth congratulates the student.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Identifying and naming 2D and 3D shapes
- Using position words to describe location
- Composing and decomposing shapes
- Building 3D structures and using shapes in art

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Kindergarten unit on spatial sense framed around Sammy the Safari Sloth and Mira the Map-Making Monkey.

Price: \$8.99 CAD

Pages: ~45

Classroom time: 175 min

Teacher prep: ~240 min

Top tags: Kindergarten, math, spatial sense, 2D shapes, 3D shapes, geometry, position words, compose decompose

What's included:

- Unit blueprint with curriculum mapping (1 file)
- 5 lesson plans with minds-on, action, consolidation, expanded walkthroughs (5 files)
 - 5 student worksheets with answer keys and image placeholders (5 files)
 - Manipulatives plan with 12 print-ready assets (1 file: 2D shape set, 3D models, safari map mat, position word cards, pattern blocks, capstone template, anchor...
 - Formative + reflection sheets (1 file: mid-unit check + end-of-unit reflection)
 - Assessment suite (1 file: diagnostic tracker, 3 formative trackers, summative rubric, summative administration guide, Junior Shape Explorer certificate)